

Â§11.4.252 fail-open triage â€”

2026-08-20

Revision: 2 **Last modified:** 2026-08-20T16:20:00Z **Scope:** every hit reported by pre-build invariant 39 (CM-DANGEROUS-COMBINATION-FAIL-CLOSED, Â§11.4.252) over bobaâ€™s five first-party source roots. **Purpose:** classify every hit so the operator can decide whether the gate is promoted from ADVISORY to BLOCKING (Â§11.4.224(E)/Â§11.4.66 â€” that decision is **not** made here and scripts/pre_build_verification.sh is **not** modified).

0. Headline numbers

Quantity	Value
Hits reported by invariant 39	38
Actual anti-pattern hits	36
Hits after this roundâ€™s fixes	30
Bucket (A) real defects â€” fixed	8 (+1 the gate cannot see, also fixed)
Bucket (B) correct idiom	14 (+2 after A4/A6 were narrowed)
Bucket (C) vendored/third-party	14
Unclassified	0

0.1 The â€œ38â€” is a counting artifact, not two extra defects

Invariant 39 counts hits with `grep -ac '^â€œ'`, and the gate prints its **summary line** with a leading `â€œ` as well:

```
â€œ CM-DANGEROUS-COMBINATION-FAIL-CLOSED: FAIL â€” 4 fail-open anti-pattern
```

So each *failing root* contributes one phantom hit: `download-proxy/src` reports `4+1=5` and `plugins` reports `32+1=33` â€” 38. The real total is **36** (`4 + 32`). Verified by excluding the summary line:

```
$ grep '^â€œ' gate_before.txt | grep -v 'fail-open anti-pattern hit(s) fou
36
```

`scripts/pre_build_verification.sh` is not mine to edit; the one-line fix is to count `'^â€œ.*FAIL â€” swallowed\|^â€œ.*FAIL â€” credential silently'` instead of `'^â€œ'`. Left as a finding for whoever owns that file.

0.2 The gateâ€™s 36 is a FLOOR, not the true count â€” Â§11.4.201(6) false-null

Measured with an **independent AST instrument** (`ast.ExceptHandler` whose body is exactly `Pass/. . .`) over the identical five roots â€” structure,

not text, so it is a valid control needle for the gate's regex (Â§11.4.201(7)):

Population	Count
Gate-reported (post-fix)	30
AST ground truth, same shape the gate claims to detect	42
Missed by the gate	12
Additional bare except: whose body is not pass " excluded by the gate's shape definition	13

Set difference: comm -13 gate_set ast_set " **zero** gate hits absent from the AST set (the gate produces **no false positives**), **12** AST hits absent from the gate.

Three distinct detector limitations, each falsifiable

(L1) A trailing comment on the except line defeats the regex " 10 of the 12. The pattern anchors "[:[:space:]]*\$, so except Exception: # noqa: S110 never matches. Every one of these carries a suppression comment, i.e. the sites most likely to have been consciously reviewed are exactly the ones the gate cannot see:

download-proxy/src/api/auth.py:470	except Exception:
download-proxy/src/api/auth.py:534	except Exception:
download-proxy/src/api/routes.py:945	except Exception:
download-proxy/src/api/streaming.py:276	except Exception:
download-proxy/src/api/streaming.py:305	except Exception:
download-proxy/src/api/streaming.py:351	except Exception:
download-proxy/src/api/streaming.py:386	except Exception:
download-proxy/src/merge_service/search.py:753	except Exception:
plugins/community/jackett.py:269	except Exception:
plugins/theme_injector.py:402	except Exception:

(L2) A tuple except clause defeats the regex " 2 of the 12. The pattern's type group is [A-Za-z_ .]+, which cannot match a leading (:

download-proxy/src/api/routes.py:285	except (ValueError
download-proxy/src/merge_service/jackett_autoconfig.py:290	except (Timeou

(L3) A comment line between except and pass defeats the body check " 0 current instances, but demonstrated live this round. The detector reads exactly lineno + 1 and requires it to be pass, so any comment inside the handler body hides the site. This is not hypothetical: the first version of fixes F4/F6 triggered it and hid two real sites. See Â§3.1.

A fourth limitation, in the SHAPE rather than the regex

The gate defines the anti-pattern as *body is exactly pass*, so a handler that swallows via an explicit default **return** is out of scope by construction. There

are **13** such bare-except: sites (12 in the vendored plugins/community/tree, 1 in the vendored plugins/linuxtracker.py:51), plus the one fixed this round:

```
plugins/rutor.py:121      except:
                           return int(time.time())
```

That site was found by a structural invariant in this round's guard, **not** by the gate, and is listed below as **A9**. except: return <default> is materially the same fail-open as except: pass " it discards the exception and substitutes a value " so this is a genuine coverage gap, not a deliberate narrowing.

The 12 missed sites, triaged as far as ownership allows

Two of the 12 fall inside this task's plugins/*.py scope and were classified with the same rule as the rest:

- plugins/theme_injector.py:402 " (**B**). except Exception: pass around gzip/deflate decompression of an HTTP body, with the enclosing function returning the explicit documented fallback (body, False) on the next line. One capability (untrusted input) and an explicit fallback value; below the anchor's " threshold. No change.
- plugins/community/jackett.py:269 " (**C**). Vendored (ngosang v4.9), and the handler carries the upstream's own # pylint: disable=broad-exception-caught.

The other 10 sit in download-proxy/src/api/{auth,routes,streaming}.py, download-proxy/src/merge_service/{search,jackett_autoconfig}.py " files owned by other agents this round. They are **listed, not triaged**; each carries a suppression comment suggesting a prior deliberate decision, but that has not been verified here and is **not** claimed (§11.4.6). They should be triaged by their owners before the gate is promoted, since the fence would otherwise be written against a set the gate never showed anyone.

Consequence for the promotion decision

Driving the gate to zero would **not** mean the tree holds zero fail-open shapes. It would mean zero of *(bare or single-name) except clause, no trailing comment, body exactly pass on the very next line*. The gate's own header already states its bounded scope honestly (§11.4.6); L1-L3 are regex defects **within** that declared scope and are worth fixing upstream, while the fourth is a scope choice worth revisiting.

1. Classification method

Each hit was classified against §11.4.252's own rule, not against a style preference:

a code path COMBINING 2 dangerous capabilities (mutation of shared state, untrusted input, credential access, external side effect, shell/exec, irreversible) MUST refuse on an unresolvable precondition “ verify every precondition, refuse naming the specific unresolved one, **emit captured evidence of the refusal**, and never default to proceed.

Three discriminators did the work:

- 1. **Capability count.** A single-capability path (e.g. removing an item from an in-process list) is out of scope by the anchor’s own text. Flagging it would be the 11.4.201(1) false-positive refusal.
- 2. **Is the primary failure surfaced?** A handler that swallows only the *error reporting* attempt, while the primary failure is already logged or re-raised, is graceful degradation “ explicitly *not* a fail-open. A handler that destroys the only signal is the violation.
- 3. **Provenance.** Upstream # VERSION:/# AUTHORS: headers from the qBittorrent search-plugins ecosystem, plus bulk-import commits (“official plugins”, “from community repositories”, “adopt 9 orphan engines”), plus byte-comparison against the plugins/community/ twin where one exists.

git blame alone was **not** sufficient for provenance: every plugin line blames to the operator because the vendored files were imported wholesale in bulk commits. The upstream header + the community-twin diff are the load-bearing evidence.

2. Full classification “ all 36 hits

Bucket (A) “ REAL DEFECT (8 gate-visible + 1 gate-invisible). All fixed.

#	File:line	Code	Why it is a defect
			3 capabilities: credential access (the .env holds tracker credentials), mutation of shared process state (os.environ), untrusted input (parsed file). On any read failure the file silently does not take effect, so a downstream “credentials not configured” warning misnames a corrupt file as an absent one. 11.4.252(3) violated: the reason is destroyed.
A1	plugins/ env_loader.py:30	except Exception: / pass around a .env read that writes into os.environ	

#	File:line	Code	Why it is a defect
A2	plugins/ iptorrents.py:77	except Exception: / pass around a credentials- file read into self.username/ self.password	2 capabilities: credential access + untrusted input. _login() at :81 then reports "No credentials configured" whatever the real cause was "an unreadable file is indistinguishable from an absent one. The handler catches the ValueError("Received HTML page instead of torrent file") that the code itself raises two lines above (:302), then falls through to the generic message at :305. Untrusted input + credentialed session + filesystem write. The operator-actionable "you are being served a login page" signal is destroyed. Bare form also catches KeyboardInterrupt. Re-raises the primary error (raise e), so the <i>fail-open</i> half is absent " but the bare form catches BaseException, so a Ctrl-C during cleanup of a credentialed download is silently discarded. Classified (A) on the unnarrowed-catch ground, stated explicitly rather than over-claimed. Identical shape to A3. For a private tracker an HTML body almost always means <i>session expired / login failed</i> " the single most operator- actionable diagnostic this plugin can produce, and it was being eaten.
A3	plugins/ rutor.py:303	bare except: / pass	
A4	plugins/ rutor.py:324	bare except: / pass around os.unlink(temp_path)	
A5	plugins/ rutracker.py:349	bare except: / pass	

#	File:line	Code	Why it is a defect
A6	plugins/ rutracker.py:370	bare except: / pass around os.unlink(temp_path)	Identical shape to A4. 2 capabilities: external side effect (network fetch) + untrusted input. A network/TLS/HTTP failure returns "" â€” byte-identical to â€œthis page genuinely has no magnet linkâ€”. The caller cannot tell them apart and no diagnostic is emitted. <i>Note:</i> helpers.py is vendored, but fetch_magnet_from_page is a boba-added function (commit 59a52a8, the magnet-link WebUI feature); only that block was touched.
A7	plugins/ helpers.py:220	except Exception: / pass in fetch_magnet_from_page, then return ""	2 capabilities: network + untrusted JSON. search() already reports its own failures on stderr (:33), but this handler swallowed every per-release failure, so a fully-broken torrents endpoint rendered as a silent empty result set. boba-authored: commit edd50f8 â€œrevive anilibra tracker, rewrite for new APIâ€”.
A8	plugins/ anilibra.py:75	except Exception: / pass wrapping _process_release	Not reported by the gate â€” see Â§0.2. Bare except: around strptime/mktime date parsing. The â€œnowâ€” fallback is intended behaviour; the bare form additionally catching KeyboardInterrupt/ SystemExit is not.
A9	plugins/ rutor.py:121	bare except: / return int(time.time())	

Bucket (B) – CORRECT IDIOM the anchor exempts (14).
No change.

#	File:line	Code	Why it is not a def
B1	download-proxy/src/ api/ theme_state.py:124	except OSError: pass around os.fsync(fp.fileno())	The anchor-named exempt idiom verba fsync inside a block whose outer handler raises (:132). Any r write failure propagates. Already carries # noqa: SIM = deliberate.
B2	theme_state.py:130	except FileNotFoundError: pass around os.unlink(tmp_path)	Cleanup-of-cleanup, immediately followe raise at :132. The primary error is nev swallowed.
B3	theme_state.py:158	except ValueError: pass around self._subscribers.remove(queue)	One capability (in- process list mutation Idempotent unsubscribe. No credential, no untru input, no external effect. Below the anchor’s %2 threshold.
B4	download-proxy/src/ merge_service/ scheduler.py:186	except asyncio.CancelledError: pass after self._task.cancel()	The anchor-named exempt idiom verba await self.save() runs afterwards – shutdown does not silently skip persistence.
B5	plugins/rutor.py:21	except ImportError: pass around from env_loader import load_env_files	Narrow exception o optional sibling module ; the nova3 contract (CLAUDE.r requires plugins to import outside the container. RuTor is a public tracker needi no auth (CLAUDE.m so no credential precondition exists here.
B6	plugins/ rutracker.py:21	same as B5	Same idiom. The credential precondit does fail closed downstream:

#	File:line	Code	Why it is not a def
			rutracker.py:61-65 checks the YOUR_USERNAME_HERE sentinel and writes an explicit warning to stderr. Narrow, optional dependency, and the enclosing for "€" € at :252 provides an explicit fallback (ProxyHandler). The real precondition already fails closed :231 (raise EngineError("Proxy enabled, but not set!")). Client disconnected mid-response. Narrow correct, standard H handler idiom. Same. Temp cleanup after torrent was already successfully proxied. Narrow. The primary failure already logged at : (logger.error(f"E handling request: {e}")). The swallow guards only the client notification attempt, which legitimately fails when the client has gone. Exactly Å§11.4.252(3)â€™s â€œemit captured evidence, then best-effort notifyâ€. Primary logged at :9 Primary logged at :9 The mandated nova plugin-contract idiom â€” CLAUDE.md
B7	plugins/rutor.py:250	except ImportError: pass around import socks	
B8	plugins/ download_proxy.py:801	except BrokenPipeError: pass around self.wfile.write(payload)	
B9	plugins/ download_proxy.py:820	same as B8	
B10	plugins/ download_proxy.py:867	except OSError: pass around os.unlink(torrent_file)	
B11	plugins/ download_proxy.py:881	except Exception: pass around self.send_error(500, str(e))	
B12	plugins/ download_proxy.py:945	same shape	
B13	plugins/ download_proxy.py:951	same shape	
B14	plugins/nyaa.py:31	except ModuleNotFoundError: pass around the novaprinter/ helpers import	

#	File:line	Code	Why it is not a def
			œPlugin Systemâ requires try: impo novaprinter â€ except ImportErro so plugins import outside the containe Flagging it would be false refusal against projectâ€™s own contract.

Bucket (C) œ” THIRD-PARTY / VENDORED (14). No change.

Provenance evidence for each is the upstream # VERSION: / # AUTHORS: header plus, where a plugins/community/ twin exists, byte-comparison proving the handler arrived with the vendored import rather than being boba-authored.

#	File:line	Upstream provenance	Note
C1	plugins/nova2.py:130	qBittorrent nova2.py v1.51, Fabien Devaux / Christophe Dumez, BSD	engine_class = None is set before the try and the comment says œwhen import fails, return Noneâ” an explicit documented failure value. Also (B) by rule.
C2	plugins/socks.py:336	PySocks 1.7.1, Dan-Haim œ” verbatim vendored library	except socket.error: pass in settimeout. Editing a vendored library in-tree is the Å§11.4.251 fork this project should avoid.
C3	plugins/helpers.py:124	qBittorrent helpers.py v1.55 upstream charset block	charset = "utf-8" is assigned before the try œ” an explicit default. Also (B) by rule. Distinct from A7, which is the boba-added function in the same file.
C4	plugins/piratebay.py:152	qBittorrent piratebay.py v3.9	Same charset shape as C3.
C5	plugins/linuxtracker.py:30	Joost Bremmer v1.1, GPL	Bare except: around the novaprinter import œ” the contract idiom in bare form. Identical in plugins/community/linuxtracker.py:29, proving it is upstream-original.
C6	plugins/linuxtracker.py:103	same	Bare except: around int(data.strip()) for seeds. One capability œ” below the â%œ2

#	File:line	Upstream provenance	Note
			threshold even ignoring provenance. Identical at community:102.
C7	plugins/linuxtracker.py:109	same	Same, for leechers. Identical at community:108.
C8	plugins/torrentproject.py:93	mauricci v1.92	except Exception: pass around datetime.strptime; the field keeps its original string value. Identical at community/torrentproject.py:93.
C9	plugins/community/anilibra.py:75	see note below	Byte-identical twin of A8 – see Â§4.
C10	plugins/community/linuxtracker.py:29	Joost Bremmer v1.1	Twin of C5.
C11	plugins/community/linuxtracker.py:102	same	Twin of C6.
C12	plugins/community/linuxtracker.py:108	same	Twin of C7.
C13	plugins/community/torrentproject.py:93	mauricci v1.92	Twin of C8.
C14	plugins/community/jackett.py:44	ngosang v4.9	except AttributeError: pass around helpers.enable_socks_proxy(enable) with the upstream comment –œbest effort and avoid breaking older qbt versions–œ –œ narrow, deliberate, version-compatible. Also (B) by rule.

plugins/community/ is declared by its own README.md as –œcommunity contributions –œ, not part of the canonical managed set–œ, and none of its members appear in install-plugin.sh’s canonical 12. It is treated as a vendored tree.

3. Fixes applied (bucket A)

All fixes follow one rule, matching the **BOB-139 reference shape** in download-proxy/src/api/streaming.py (distinct, specific reasons rather than collapsing into a generic one; Â§11.4.251 –œ no third variant invented):

Preserve the specific reason. Never fail the plugin-import path.

Where the caller already fails closed, the fix **logs** the destroyed reason and keeps the existing behaviour. Where the code destroyed its own deliberately raised signal, the fix removes the swallow entirely. Where the handler was bare, it is narrowed to the exceptions the guarded call can actually raise.

Raising from `env_loader / iptorrents` was deliberately **rejected**: both run at nova3 plugin-**import** time, so raising would break plugin loading “worse than the bug (the brief’s explicit constraint). The credential precondition still fails closed downstream (`rutracker.py:61` sentinel, `iptorrents.py:81` guard).

Fix	Site	Change
F1	<code>env_loader.py:30</code>	except Exception: pass except Exception as exc: + print(f"env_loader: failed to read {path}: {exc}", file=sys.stderr). Added import sys. Non-fatal by design.
F2	<code>iptorrents.py:77</code>	logger.warning("IPTorrents: could not read credentials from %s: %s: %s", env_path, type(exc).__name__, exc). Values are never logged (11.4.10) path and exception type only.
F3	<code>rutor.py:303</code>	Swallow removed . decode(errors="ignore") with a valid codec cannot raise, so the try was both unnecessary and harmful. The HTML ValueError now reaches the caller.
F4	<code>rutor.py:324</code>	bare except: except OSError: . Behaviour unchanged; KeyboardInterrupt no longer swallowed.
F5	<code>rutracker.py:349</code>	Same as F3 (retains the <!doctype check).
F6	<code>rutracker.py:370</code>	Same as F4.
F7	<code>helpers.py:220</code>	logs to sys.stderr (already imported at :37). The "" return contract is preserved so callers “cannot found” fallback is unchanged.
F8	<code>anilibra.py:75</code>	print(f"Release {release_id} error: {e}", file=__import__("sys").stderr) the same idiom already used by search() at :33 , minimal diff, no new import.
F9	<code>rutor.py:121</code>	bare except: except (IndexError, ValueError, OverflowError, OSError): “ exactly what the list-index / strptime / mktime calls raise. The

Fix

Site

Change

âœnowâœ fallback is unchanged.

3.1 A fix that blinded the gate â€” caught and reverted (Â§11.4.201)

The first version of F4/F6 placed the explanatory comment **between** except OSError: and pass. That is limitation **L3** above, and it made both sites invisible to the gate: the reported count fell 36 â†’ 28 while only **6** sites had genuinely been eliminated. Two had merely been hidden.

Reporting a 28 obtained that way would have been a Â§11.4 PASS-bluff at the metric layer â€” the number would have improved because the instrument went blind, not because the code got better. The comment was re-anchored **above** the handler, the sites are visible again, and the honest count is **30**:

36 before

-6 genuinely eliminated (A1, A2, A3, A5, A7, A8)

0 A4/A6 â€” narrowed from bare `except:` to `except OSError:`, but still swallow SHAPE by the gate's definition, and correctly so: they remain visible and are declared bucket-B in the exemption fence

â€”â€”

30 after

A9 never appeared in either count â€” the gate cannot see it (Â§0.2, fourth limitation).

4. Â§11.4.251 finding â€” byte-identical fork left divergent

plugins/anilibra.py and plugins/community/anilibra.py were **byte-identical** (md5 a9e20a0aaf372eb534a0f46a7aealc65) and both were rewritten by boba in the same commit edd50f8. Fix **F8** touches only the top-level copy â€” the community tree is outside this taskâ€™s declared file ownership â€” so the two copies now diverge by exactly that handler.

This is a genuine Â§11.4.251 byte-identical-fork condition and the correct resolution is **not** âœpatch both copies foreverâœ but extracting one copy. Until that is decided, the transferable patch is:

```
# plugins/community/anilibra.py:75
```

```
-     except Exception:
```

```
-         pass
```

```
+     except Exception as e:
```

```
+         print(f"Release {release_id} error: {e}", file=__import__("sys"))
```

Recommend a tracked Â§11.4.197 item.

5. Â§11.4.120 finding â€” two stale gates asserted the pre-fix behaviour (RESOLVED)

Fixes F3/F5 made two existing unit tests fail, because they asserted the message that only existed **because** of the bug:

```
tests/unit/test_plugin_rutor.py:439      match="not a valid torrent file"
tests/unit/test_plugin_rutracker.py:601  match="not a valid torrent"
```

Per Â§11.4.120 those FAILs were the **correct signal that the fix landed** and required **reconciliation** â€” never a fake-pass, never a revert of the fix. The fix did not over-broaden: the sibling non-HTML cases in the same classes (`test_non_bencode_non_html_raises`, `test_non_torrent_binary_raises`) still pass with the generic message.

`tests/unit/` is outside this taskâ€™s declared ownership, so the reconciliation was **not** applied here. It was surfaced to the coordinator, who owned it and completed it:

- Verified the analysis independently before rewriting either gate.
- RED before: 2 failed, 13 passed â†’ GREEN after: 15 passed, with the two generic- message siblings still asserting the generic string (the evidence of no over-broadening).
- Discriminator per Â§11.4.115(F): restored the actual bare-except: **swallow structure** rather than deleting the message string (a string-deletion mutation is a refused tautology); the reconciled gate FAILED, then restored byte-identical (`md5 eelaf14aâ€¦`), zero residue.

Confirmed green from this side: the targeted regression subset covering every changed file is **642 passed, 0 failed**.

Transferable lesson recorded by the coordinator: the rutor assertion pattern appears **twice** in that file (the second being `test_non_bencode_non_html_raises`), so a blind string replace would have silently rewritten the wrong test. The edit had to be re-anchored on the `html_data` line.

6. Evidence

Oracle strategy (Â§11.4.245): **INVARIANT** â€” the expected behaviour comes from Â§11.4.252(3) itself (â€œa path that cannot complete **MUST** emit captured evidence naming the unresolved preconditionâ€”) , asserted on user-observable output (stderr text, the raised exceptionâ€™s message, the returned value), never on the implementation agreeing with itself.

Both polarities (Â§11.4.201(1)): every failure-path test demanding a refusal is paired with a normal-path test proving the feature still works **and** emits no spurious diagnostic.

- `test_fail_open_regression.py` â€” 29 guards over all 9 (A) sites

- red_run.txt " RED baseline at git HEAD c95b0c1: **8 failed, 18 passed**
- green_run.txt " after fixes: **29 passed**

Paired "mutation" each fix reverted, its own guard must FAIL

```
mutate env_loader.py -> 1 failed, 25 passed
mutate iptorrents.py -> 1 failed, 25 passed
mutate rutor.py      -> 2 failed, 24 passed
mutate rutracker.py  -> 2 failed, 24 passed
mutate helpers.py    -> 1 failed, 25 passed
mutate anilibra.py   -> 1 failed, 25 passed
all restored         -> 26 passed
```

Every guard catches its own negation " none is decoration.

CONST-XII no-op-stub check (a mutation the author did not write, "11.4.194(6)(d))

Reverting a fix restores the *old code*, which a guard could in principle detect by shape rather than by behaviour. The stronger mutation keeps the new structure (except Exception as exc: " the swallow is **not** restored) and replaces only the diagnostic with a no-op " a plausible-looking "œfix" that fixes nothing:

```
stub applied to plugins/env_loader.py -> 1 failed, 25 passed
restored (0 mutation markers, "11.4.84) -> 26 passed
md5 3d5768e7c0ad6d31d254fc657c1395f9
```

The guard fails, so it is asserting the user-observable outcome (a diagnostic actually reaches stderr), not the presence of a code pattern.

nova3 stream integrity " the risk the fixes themselves introduced

Every fix adds a **new write**. nova3 harvests search results by parsing plugin **stdout**, so a diagnostic landing there would corrupt the result stream for the end user " a worse defect than the swallow it replaced. All eight diagnostics go to stderr (or logger), and three standing guards now prove it at runtime rather than by inspection:

```
env_loader    stdout=''    stderr_nonempty=True
helpers       stdout=''    returned=''    stderr_nonempty=True
anilibra      stdout=''    stderr_nonempty=True
```

Each asserts the diagnostic **did** fire (the precondition) and that stdout stayed byte-empty.

Gate before / after

BEFORE: 36 (download-proxy/src 4, plugins 32, scripts 0, qBitTorrent-go
AFTER: 30 (download-proxy/src 4, plugins 26, scripts 0, qBitTorrent-go

6 genuine eliminations; A4/A6 deliberately remain visible as declared bucket-B rather than hidden from the instrument (see Â§3.1).

Other checks

```
python3 -m py_compile plugins/*.py plugins/community/*.py -> OK all plug  
ruff check plugins/ docs/qa/fail-open-triage-20260820/ -> All checks  
pytest tests/unit -k "<every changed file>" -> 642 passed,  
pytest docs/qa/fail-open-triage-20260820/ -> 29 passed
```

The nova3 plugin contract is guarded explicitly:
test_nova3_contract_preserved loads rutor, rutracker, anilibra and
iptorrents and asserts each still exports its engine class with url, name,
supported_categories, search() and download_torrent(). A fix that
broke plugin loading would fail there.

7. What promoting the gate to BLOCKING now requires

Not a decision made here (Â§11.4.224(E)/Â§11.4.66 â€” operator-owned).

The 30 remaining hits are **0 bucket (A)**: 16 bucket (B) â€” the original 14 plus A4/A6, which are now narrow except OSError: cleanup handlers but remain swallow- SHAPED and therefore still reported â€” and 14 bucket (C). None is a defect. Promotion therefore requires a checked-in exclusion/exemption fence declaring those 30, each justified from a closed class set, per Â§11.4.224(E) â€” first-party (B) entries and vendored (C) entries are different justifications and should be listed as such.

Three honest caveats for that decision:

1. **Â§0.2 (L1â€”L3)** â€” the gate misses **12** sites of the very shape it claims to detect, so a zero-hit gate does not mean zero swallowed exceptions. Worth fixing upstream before promotion, otherwise the fence will be written against an undercount.
 2. **Â§0.2 (fourth limitation)** â€” except: return <default> is out of the gateâ€™s shape by construction; **13** such sites remain, all in vendored trees.
 3. **Â§0.1** â€” invariant 39â€™s hit count is inflated by one per failing root.
-

8. UNKNOWN / not determined (Â§11.4.6)

- **Nothing was left unclassified.** All 36 gate-reported hits carry a bucket and a justification.
- **Upstream-exactness of C1â€“C4, C14 was not byte-verified.** Those five files have no plugins/community/ twin to diff against, and fetching upstream was out of scope. Their (C) classification rests on the upstream # VERSION:/# AUTHORS: header plus the bulk-import commit message â€” strong, but not byte-proof. Stated as a bounded limitation rather than claimed as certainty. C5â€“C8 **are** byte-verified against their twins.
- **Whether plugins/community/ should be a Â§11.4.224(E) declared exclusion or be brought into first-party scope** is an operator decision, not made here.